

module-12-movement-of-sun - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - middle band

Module 12 — Movement of the Sun (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Sūrya-gati* · **Band:** Middle (6-8) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

Solar year, solstices, equinoxes, and the 12 rāśis.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 12's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

Project a sunrise-direction composite (12 photos, one per month, same location). “*The sunrise drifts north and south through the year. Why?*” (Earth's axial tilt.) “*Today: the Indian framework — uttarāyaṇa, dakṣiṇāyana, and the 12 rāśis.*”

Core idea · 15 min

The Sun's annual journey:

1. **Axial tilt** (23.5°) → Sun's apparent path drifts north/south.
 2. **Uttarāyaṇa** (Dec 21 → June 21): Sun rises further north each day.
 3. **Dakṣiṇāyana** (June 21 → Dec 21): Sun rises further south each day.
 4. **Solstices:** June 21 (Sun farthest north), Dec 21 (farthest south).
 5. **Equinoxes:** March 21, Sept 22 (Sun crosses the equator, day = night everywhere).
 6. **12 rāśis:** the ecliptic divided into $12 \times 30^\circ$ segments. Sun travels through ~1 rāśi per month.
 7. **Saṅkrānti:** the day Sun moves from one rāśi to the next. Makara Saṅkrānti (Sun enters Capricorn) ~ Jan 14.
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Demonstration · 10 min

Globe + torch demo: tilt the globe, walk torch around. Show how axial tilt creates seasons. Compute today's ayanāmśa (use a panchanga app).

Source moment · 5 min

Paraphrase Sūrya-siddhānta, ch. 14: “*The Sun travels along the ecliptic. In one year it completes one revolution through the 12 rāśis.*”

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Personal solar calendar. Mark current month, ayanāṁśa, current rāśi, next saṅkrānti. Predict your birthday’s rāśi (use a panchanga). Compare with classmates.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

“*Why does Makara Saṅkrānti (Jan 14) not match the December solstice exactly? What does the gap tell us?*”

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — Sun’s yearly path
- **Day 02** — Axial tilt and seasons
- **Day 03** — Uttarāyaṇa and Dakṣiṇāyana
- **Day 04** — Equinoxes — viṣuva
- **Day 05** — 12 rāśis
- **Day 06** — Saṅkrānti moments
- **Day 07** — Sāyana vs nirayana — the ayanāṁśa
- **Day 08** — Precession of equinoxes
- **Day 09** — Cross-cultural calendars — solar systems
- **Day 10** — Final share + personal calendar

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.